



/50

PRINTED AT

APRIL 2026

Diesel \$3.05/L

FLAT STICK is a zine documenting my trip around Australia. All photos are mine, taken on 35mm film & developed in the van. zines are printed in the great public libraries of Australia

To follow along with the journey & see other zines please visit:

FLATSTICKZINE.GITHUB.IO

ON THE ROAD



Having been on the road a while now it always feels so strange that we do this, the road is constantly reminding us of its dangers, that in a split second we could become the next statistic. The road is littered with roadkill, blown tyres, crashed cars, potholes & roadside memorials. The potholes have been particularly bad after the big wet this year, there were some big tyre bursters with the skid marks & rubber to prove it. So remember kids drive safe!

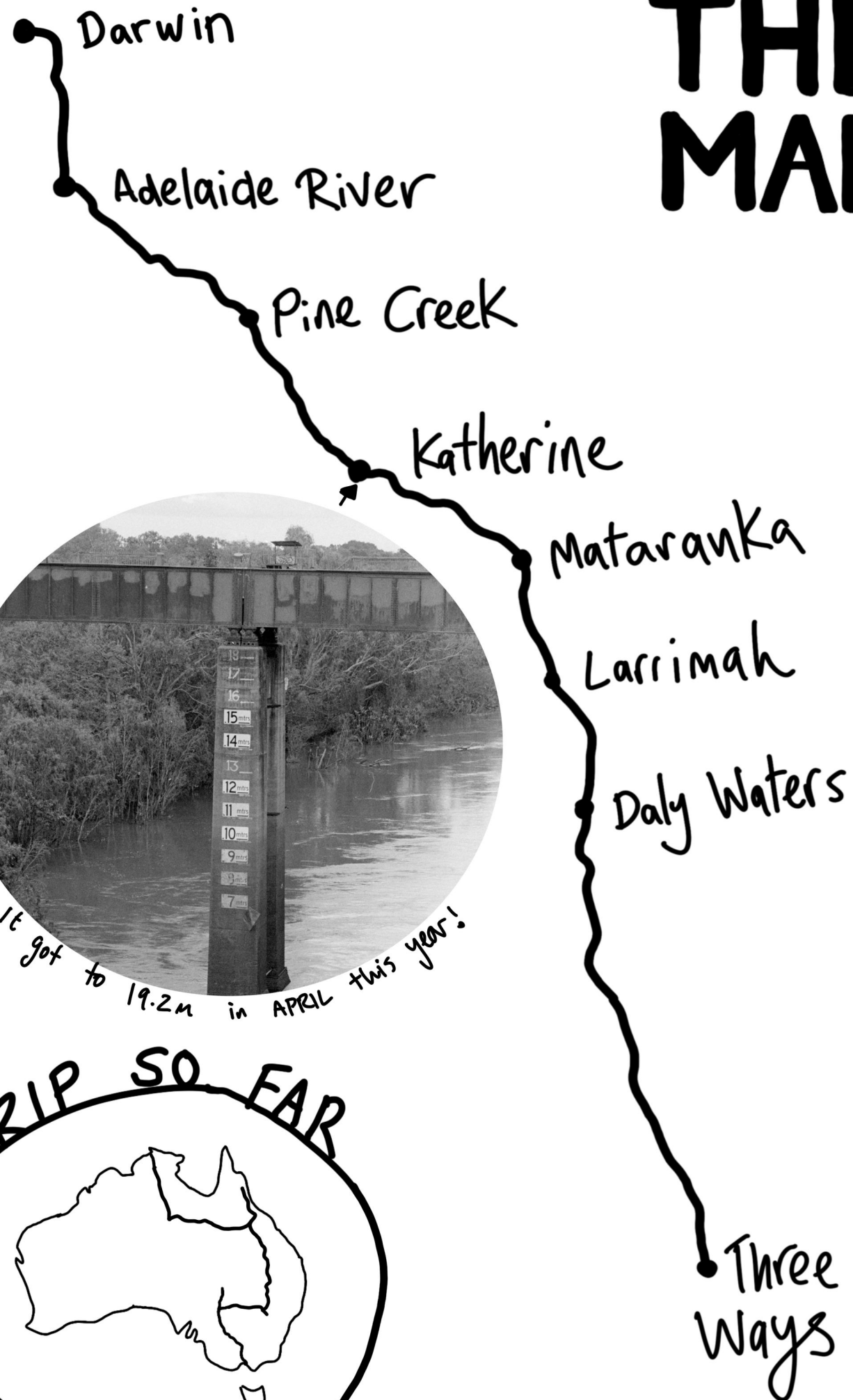


Welcome,

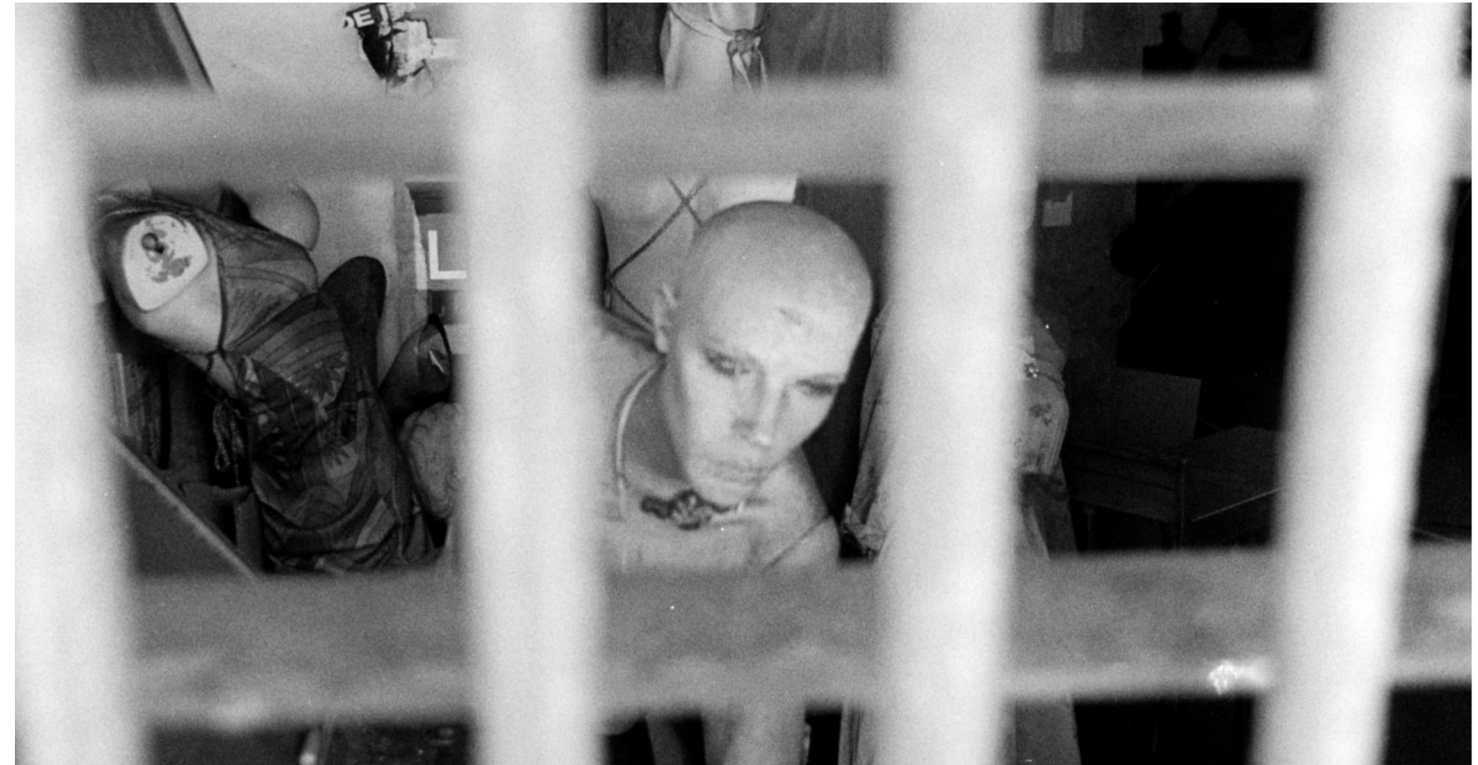
This was my 4th time travelling
the Stuart Hwy, once known
as "The Track" & only sealed in
1987. I was on the straight and
narrow upto DARWIN, slowly
becoming more tropical, greener,
wetter & humid as I got
closer to my old haunt.

love Jared _{xx}

THE MAP



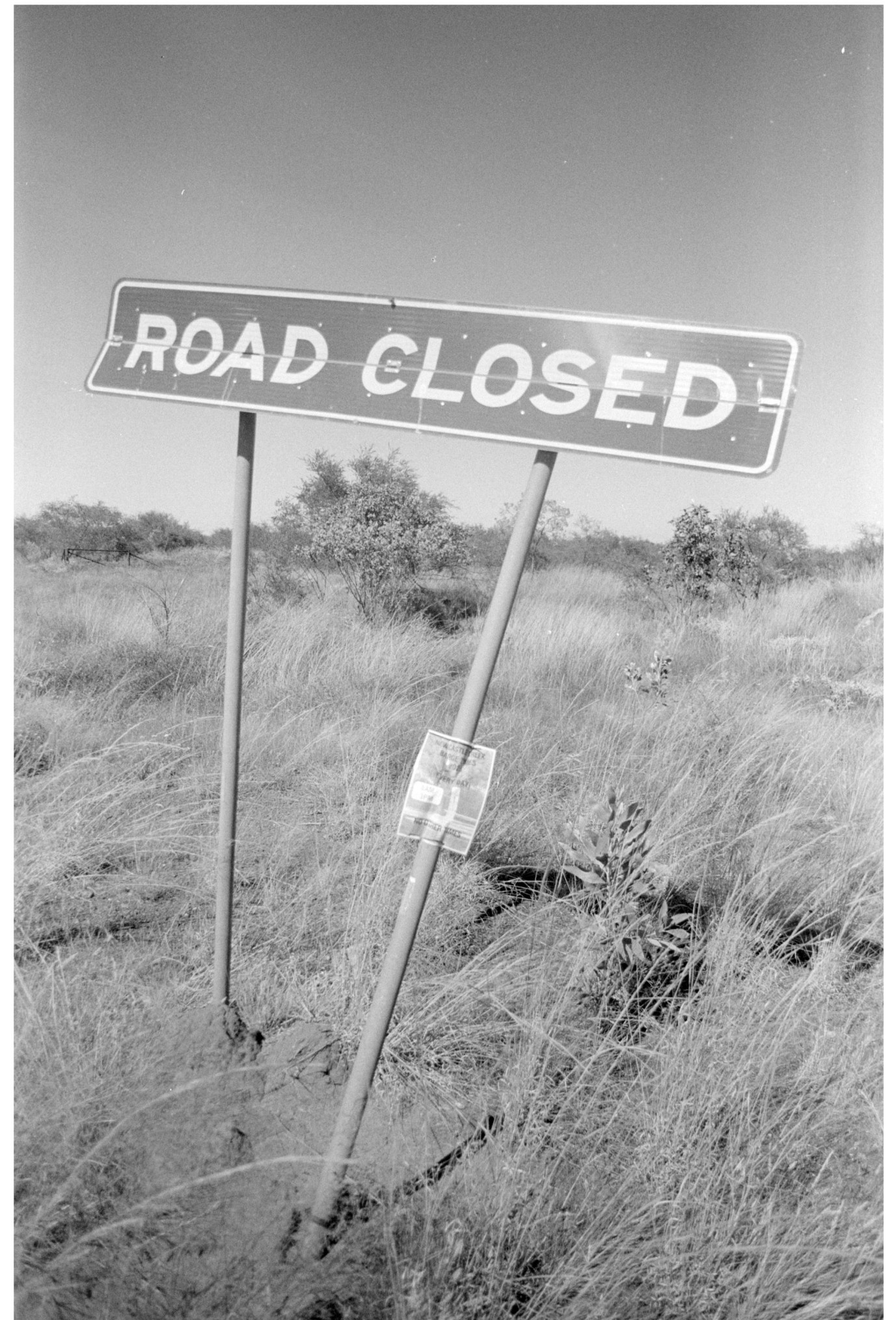
DEADLINE



The world has been in such a state of flux since I started this trip & I was hoping it may have settled down by now. If anything its only got worse. TRUMPS recent statement that a "Whole Civilisation will die tonight, never to be brought back again", even by his standards, was just reprehensible. I didn't realise the stress it put me under until TRUMP backed down. I had made sure I made it to Katherine & filled the tank so I could get to DARWIN. Its like the future is this unknown & unable to plan. Everything, as the seppos say, can turn on a dime. We live in interesting times.



The Territory is well known for having the highest speed limit in AUSTRALIA at 130Kmph (80mph) coming into force in 2007 before then there was no speed limit at all. This was most famously advertised by the 1994 CANNONBALL RUN. A 4000Km race from DARWIN to ULURU held on the open Stuart Hwy, with over 100 entrants from the world over entering all that was needed was a drivers licence & a car. A Ferrari F-40 driven by a Japanese dentist, Akihiro Kabe, clocked a speed of 280Kmph! on one section. The race ended in tragedy when the Ferrari F40 crashed at a checkpoint, killing two race officials as well as the driver & navigator. The race was never held again.



ATTACK CREEK



The Stuart Hwy is named after John McDouall Stuart, a Scottish explorer, who on his 6th attempt in 1861-1862 transversed the mainland from South to North. His many attempts left him in such bad health he died in 1866 in LONDON. His route was the basis for the telegraph line & then the highway named in his honour. On Stuart's forth attempt he made it to the above creek, north of Tennant Creek. Stuart wrote he encountered an old Aboriginal man who made hand signals one of which was a masonic symbol he returned, the old man patted him on the shoulder & gave him an edible root. Later the Aboriginal people returned wanting something in return & Stuart gave the order to fire as the exchange got heated. Stuart sick with scurvy & low on supplies decided to turn back to Adelaide. It appears the symbol shown by the Warumungu man was likely that of trade, the event a cross-cultural misunderstanding, the first of many more to come.



DALY WATERS



The iconic Daly Waters pub has a rich history & continues today as one of the best stops on the Stuart Hwy. The town lies on the border of the Jingili (Daly waters down to Renner Springs) & the Yangman (around Mataranka to Daly waters) people. The area however wasn't frequented often as it was believed to be inhabited by the Kurdaikha man, a traditional spirit or executioner figure. Named by Stuart on his 3rd and successful attempt at reaching Australia's north, was a stopping place due to its natural spring. The airport became a vital refueling spot for QANTAS flights to Singapore & later a key airforce base during WWII. It also hosted the NT's only B&S (bachelor & sheilas) ball up until 2019.



